



Soul Food Break*fast



Created By: Dr. D Brown

Foundation in Christ | Adult Edition

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break · fast - Month 1

Adult Edition

 Theme:

Part I: Prayer, the First Resort

⁶In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. -Phil 4:6 (WEB)

COPYRIGHT

Soul Food Series – Bible Study Workbook © 2025

Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown, MBAE, MSIT, DD. All rights reserved.

Published by:

Overflow Harvest, LLC Springfield, Massachusetts, USA

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means—electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, scanning, or otherwise—without prior written permission of the publisher, except as permitted by United States copyright law.

Soul Food Series and all related content, designs, and lesson formats are trademarks or service marks of Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown and are used under exclusive license through Overflow Harvest, LLC.

Usage for Churches & Small Groups

Churches and ministries are encouraged to purchase one workbook per participant whenever possible, to honor the labor and resources invested in this project. Permission is granted to reproduce brief excerpts (such as a single activity page, lesson question set, or prayer) for classroom or church use provided that:

- No fee is charged for the reproduced pages, and
- The following credit is included:

“Excerpted from the Soul Food Series by Dr. Shefa ‘Dee’ Brown. Used with permission.”

Scripture Credits

Unless otherwise indicated, all Scripture quotations are taken from the *World English Bible* (WEB), which is in the public domain.

Disclaimer

This book is designed as a Bible study and devotional resource. It is not intended to replace professional counseling, pastoral covering, medical care, or legal/financial advice. Readers are encouraged to seek appropriate professional help when needed and to remain connected to a Bible-believing local church.

Adult First Edition: 2025

ISBN (print): 979-8-9940733-2-2

DIGITAL (pdf): 979-8-9940733-3-9

Printed in the United States of America

All rights reserved.

DEDICATION

This work is dedicated first and foremost to the Lord Jesus Christ, the Living Word and true Bread of Life. May every page point back to Him.

To every hungry heart that has ever sat in a pew, at a kitchen table, on a lunch break, or in a quiet corner whispering, “Lord, I want to understand Your Word, but I don’t know where to start”—these lessons were written with you in mind. You are not invisible to God, and you are not too late for His promises.

To the intercessors, pastors, teachers, and destiny helpers who labor in prayer and service behind the scenes: your obedience, your “yes,” and your unseen sacrifices are the soil this work has grown from. May God reward you in ways no book could ever fully acknowledge.

And to every believer who has ever felt like “leftovers on the table of life,” may you discover through these pages that in God’s Kingdom you are never an afterthought. You are the guest of honor at a table He prepared just for you.

With love and gratitude,

Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown

Creator, SOFU Bible Study Series

QUICK START FOR LEADERS

Who this is for:

Pastors, ministers, small group leaders, Sunday school teachers, and facilitators using the Soul Food Series in any gathering (church, home, online, or community setting).

Session Length & Rhythm

- Recommended session time: 60–75 minutes
- Ideal pace: 1 lesson per week (or biweekly for deeper processing)
- Group size: 4–15 people works best.

Basic Flow for Each Lesson

1. Welcome & Prayer (5–10 min)
2. Appetizer (10–15 min)
3. Main Course: Bites + CST (30–35 min)
4. Dessert & To-Go Box (10–15 min)
5. Closing Prayer (5 min)

Tips for Leading Well

- Create a safe space; remind the group that what is shared stays in the group (w/ appropriate exceptions for safety).
- Honor time by starting and ending close to schedule.
- Let the Holy Spirit lead; the questions are a guide, not a cage.
- Model honesty and vulnerability.
- Invite participation, not performance.

Using Activities & Games

Use Trivia Mix-Up (Millionaire-style) and Tricky Testaments (Jeopardy-style) as openers to review the previous lesson or as closers to reinforce the current one. Let youth or emerging leaders help read questions, track scores, or lead a round to build ownership and confidence.

Before Each Session

- Read the Background Text and lesson in advance.
- (Optional) Play the audio companion track.
- Pray for wisdom, discernment, and sensitivity.
- Ask God who might need extra encouragement that day.

You don't have to be a Bible scholar to lead. You just have to be willing, teachable, and available. God will take care of the rest.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Breakfast Series

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES	1
COPYRIGHT.....	3
DEDICATION	4
QUICK START FOR LEADERS	5
TABLE OF CONTENTS.....	6
PROLOGUE.....	11
Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”	12
 Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther.....	13
Second <i>IS</i> the Best	13
 Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17	13
 Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage.....	14
 Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14	14
 Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Est 4:15–16.....	14
 Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7.....	14
 BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon	18
 The Question That Unlocked a Legacy.....	18
 Appetizer — When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7	18
 Main Course	19
 Bite 1 — Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-10	19
 Bite 2 — God’s Response, 2 Chron 1:11–12.....	19
 Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30	20
 BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus	22
 Prayer the First Resort	22
 Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16.....	22
 Main Course – The Mediator and the Model.....	22
 Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4.....	22
 Bite 2 — Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5	23

 Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust, Judge, Luke 18:6–8.....	23
 BM1 — Lesson 4 Paul & Silas	26
 Faith in the Dark.....	26
 Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3	26
 Main Course – Power in the Praises.....	26
 Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31	26
 Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26.....	27
 Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30.....	27
SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES	1
COPYRIGHT.....	3
DEDICATION	4
QUICK START FOR LEADERS.....	5
TABLE OF CONTENTS.....	6
PROLOGUE.....	11
Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”.....	12
 Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther.....	13
Second <i>IS</i> the Best.....	13
 Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17	13
 Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage.....	14
 Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14.....	14
 Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Est 4:15–16.....	14
 Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7.....	14
 BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon	18
 The Question That Unlocked a Legacy.....	18
 Appetizer — When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7	18
 Main Course	19
 Bite 1 — Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-10	19
 Bite 2 — God’s Response, 2 Chron 1:11–12.....	19
 Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30	20
 BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus	22

 Prayer the First Resort	22
 Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16.....	22
 Main Course – The Mediator and the Model.....	22
 Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4.....	22
 Bite 2 — Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5	23
 Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust, Judge, Luke 18:6–8.....	23
 BM1 — Lesson 4 Paul & Silas	26
 Faith in the Dark.....	26
 Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3	26
 Main Course – Power in the Praises.....	26
 Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31	26
 Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26.....	27
 Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30.....	27
 Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key	31
Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best.....	31
Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	32
Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort.....	32
Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark.....	33
 Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key	31
SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES	1
COPYRIGHT.....	3
DEDICATION	4
QUICK START FOR LEADERS.....	5
TABLE OF CONTENTS.....	6
PROLOGUE.....	11
Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”	12
 Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther.....	13
Second <i>IS</i> the Best.....	13

 Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17	13
 Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage.....	14
 Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14.....	14
 Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Est 4:15–16.....	14
 Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7.....	14
 BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon	18
 The Question That Unlocked a Legacy.....	18
 Appetizer — When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7	18
 Main Course	19
 Bite 1 — Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-10	19
 Bite 2 — God’s Response, 2 Chron 1:11–12.....	19
 Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30	20
 BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus	22
 Prayer the First Resort	22
 Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16.....	22
 Main Course – The Mediator and the Model.....	22
 Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4.....	22
 Bite 2 — Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5	23
 Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust, Judge, Luke 18:6–8.....	23
 BM1 — Lesson 4 Paul & Silas	26
 Faith in the Dark.....	26
 Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3	26
 Main Course – Power in the Praises.....	26
 Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31	26
 Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26.....	27
 Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30.....	27
 Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key	31
Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best.....	31

Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	32
Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort.....	32
Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark.....	33
Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best.....	31
Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	32
Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort.....	32
Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark.....	33

All scriptures are from the World English Bible (WEB) unless otherwise noted.

PROLOGUE

“Prayer for Divine Connection”

In the quiet of my heart, I seek Your face,
Elohim, Jesus Christ, fountain of grace.
Through ancient paths where prophets once trod,
I reach beyond the veil to touch my God.

Your Word, a lamp that guides through darkest night,
Transforms my weakness into holy might.
The Holy Spirit breathes where faith is born,
Three persons, one God—Father, Spirit, Son.

In perfect unity, the Trinity divine,
The Comforter within, Your presence mine.
The body of Christ, united as one,
Brother and sister beneath Your sun.

In family ties, both blood and spirit-bound,
Your kingdom's strength on earth is found.
When others stumble, empathy extends my hand,
With sympathy I weep, I pray, I stand.

The Spirit intercedes with groans too deep for words,
An advocate whose whispers always heard.
For we are woven in Your love's design,
Each thread of mercy, wholly Thine.

Through sacrifice You broke sin's heavy chain,
Now in Your presence, I am born again.
The Spirit seals us, marked as heaven's own,
Until we stand before the eternal throne.

-S. L. Doctor

Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”

“In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. -Phil 4:6 (WEB)

Before we can truly walk with God, we must first learn to talk with Him. Prayer is not simply a religious routine or a spiritual exercise—it is the first resort that ushers us into a genuine, living relationship with our Creator. From the very beginning, God desired fellowship with humanity, and prayer is the divine pathway through which that fellowship is restored and maintained.



When we pray, we are not informing God of what He does not know; rather, we are inviting Him into the center of our hearts, our situations, and our lives. Prayer is the language of dependence, the heartbeat of faith, and the foundation of intimacy with the Father. It is through prayer that our hearts are softened, our minds are renewed, and our will begins to align with His.

Jesus Himself modeled this truth. Before every major decision, miracle, and moment of ministry, He withdrew to pray (Luke 5:16). His life demonstrated that relationship with the Father was sustained through continual communion. If the Son of God needed prayer to remain connected, how much more do we?

Prayer is not the result of a relationship—it is the beginning of it. It is the open door into knowing God personally, hearing His voice, and walking in His purpose. As we begin this study, let us approach prayer not as a duty but as an invitation—a sacred escort leading us deeper into the presence and love of God.

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY

Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther

Second /S the Best

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** Esther 1–4 (focus on chapters 2–4)

 **Key Verse:** Esther 4:14 (WEB)

“For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**”

Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17

“The king loved Esther more than all the women, and she obtained favor and kindness in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown on her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti.” --Esther 2:17

Queen Vashti was breathtaking, bold, and unapologetically defiant — so when King Ahasuerus (Xerxes) summoned her to show off her beauty, she refused. Her refusal cost her the crown. A kingdom-wide search began for her replacement. Esther, a Jewish orphan raised by her cousin Mordecai, was chosen and crowned queen — not by luck, but divine placement.

Meanwhile, Haman was promoted, and the king commanded people to bow before him. Everyone complied except Mordecai. His refusal — rooted in the Ten Commandments — enraged Haman, who immediately plotted genocide.

CST Reflection:

Have you ever faced backlash for simply doing the right thing?



Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage



Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14

“Then Mordecai asked them to return this answer to Esther: ‘Don’t think to yourself that you will escape in the king’s house any more than all the Jews. For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish.

Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?’”

Esther learns that her crown cannot shield her from Haman’s decree. Mordecai positions her heart: This is bigger than beauty. Bigger than privilege. This is purpose.

□ CST Reflection:

When have you realized that your position was actually an assignment?



Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Est 4:15–16

“Go, gather together all the Jews who are present in Susa, and **fast for me**, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day. I also and my maidens will fast in the same way. Then I will go in to the king, which is against the law; and if I perish, I perish.”

Esther requested a three-day fast — not a last resort, but a spiritual repositioning. Fasting clarifies. Fasting strengthens. Fasting shifts atmospheres. God was aligning Esther’s courage with divine timing.



Fasting Note: Always consult your pastor and doctor before engaging in fasting if you have health concerns.

□ CST Reflection:

What personal “fear barrier” do you need to fast through?



Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7

⁷Then King Ahasuerus said to Esther the queen and to Mordecai the Jew, “See, I have given Esther the house of Haman, and they have hanged him on the gallows because he laid his hand on the Jews. ⁸Write also to the Jews as it pleases you, in the king’s name, and seal it with the king’s ring; for the writing which is written in the king’s name, and sealed with the king’s ring, may not be reversed by any man.”

The same gallows Haman built for Mordecai became the tool of his own undoing.

When Esther stepped into purpose, God shifted everything:

- A decree reversed
- A nation rescued
- The enemy exposed
- Honor restored

□ **CST Reflection:**

Where in your life can God turn evil intentions into divine promotion?

 Dessert – God Works ALL Things Together, Rom 8:28

“We know that all things work together for good for those who love God, to those who are called according to his purpose.”

Esther didn’t come from royalty — she walked into it through obedience.

God used:

- her identity
- her humility
- her courage
- her fasting
- her placement

...to preserve an entire people. This is not a coincidence. This is covenant protection in action.

 To-Go Box — Take This with You

God positions before He promotes.

Purpose requires courage.

Fasting unlocks clarity.

And obedience activates destiny.

Write one short spiritual nugget you’re taking with you:

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for divine placement and divine purpose. Strengthen us like Esther to stand boldly, speak wisely, and obey quickly—even when fear rises. Teach us to fast, to listen, and to move when You call. And remind us that You are the God who turns every evil plot into a testimony of Your power. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Write a short prayer about one thing you want to start praying about:

Review Questions

1. Who was King Ahasuerus’ first wife?

2. Why were the Jews’ lives threatened?

3. How long were they called to a fast?

4. What did Esther risk by going before the king unsummoned?

Activity – Mix & Match

Match	Name/Phrase	Description
	1 Haman	A Esther’s Cousin
	2 Mordecai	B Wanted to destroy Jews
	3 Vashti	C Death for coming without summons
	4 Why Fast was called	D Refused to come when summoned
	5 How Haman died	E By hanging at the Gallows

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Word Study

“King Ahasuerus” = Xerxes in some translations.

“Shushan” = Susa.

Practical counsel on fasting (consult pastor/doctor as applicable).



Notes & Group Discussion

BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon

The Question That Unlocked a Legacy

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** 1 Kings 3:5–14; 2 Chron 1:7–12; 1 Kings 4:29–30

 **Key Verse:** 1 Kings 3:9 (WEB)

“Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this your great people?”

Appetizer — When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7

⁵ In Gibeon Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream by night; and God said, “Ask for what you want me to give you.” ⁶ Solomon said, “You have shown to your servant David my father great loving kindness, according as he walked before you in truth, righteousness, and uprightness of heart with you. You have kept for him this great loving kindness, that you have given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is today.

⁷ Now, Yahweh my God, you have made your servant king instead of David my father. I am just a little child. I don’t know how to go out or come in.

When God met Solomon in Gibeon, He didn’t start with a demand—He started with an invitation. Solomon could have asked for power, revenge, or riches. Instead, his first instinct was to talk with God about how to lead well. Before crowns and kingdoms, God tested the posture of his heart.

CST Reflection

Before greatness begins, God often tests the posture of the heart. When God hands us a “blank check” moment, what we ask for reveals what we truly value—comfort, control, or kingdom wisdom.

Reflection Question

When God gives you a blank check of opportunity, what would your prayer reveal about your heart’s priorities?



Main Course



Bite 1 — Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-10

⁹ Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this great people of yours? ¹⁰ This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing.

Solomon could have used prayer as a way to secure more comfort for himself. Instead, he asked for an understanding heart to serve God's people well. God was pleased, not because the words sounded spiritual, but because the request was selfless and aligned with His purposes.

□ CST

True prayer doesn't manipulate—it aligns. Solomon's request pleased God because it flowed from a heart that valued wisdom to serve over wealth to be seen.

Reflect:

How might your prayer life change if you sought God's heart before His hand?



Bite 2 — God's Response, 2 Chron 1:11–12

¹¹ God said to Solomon, "Because this was in your heart, and you have not asked riches, wealth, honor, or the life of those who hate you, nor yet have you asked for long life; but have asked for wisdom and knowledge for yourself, that you may judge my people, over whom I have made you king, ¹²therefore wisdom and knowledge is granted to you. I will give you riches, wealth, and honor, such as none of the kings have had who have been before you, and none after you will have."

God granted Solomon what he asked for—wisdom and understanding—and then added what he didn't ask for: riches, wealth, and honor. When wisdom comes first, blessings can follow without becoming idols. God can trust us with more when our heart is set on serving His people instead of promoting ourselves.

□ CST Reflection

God rewards those who seek understanding before abundance. When you desire wisdom more than you desire status, you make room for God to add what you never thought to ask for.

Reflect:

Where in your life do you feel pressure to chase “riches and honor” instead of asking first for wisdom to serve well?



Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30

“God gave Solomon wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and very great understanding, even as the sand that is on the seashore. Solomon’s wisdom excelled the wisdom of all the children of the east, and all the wisdom of Egypt.”

Solomon’s wisdom became his reputation. People knew him not just for what he had, but for the way he thought, judged, and led. What began as a private conversation with God in a dream turned into a public legacy that reached the nations. Solomon’s story shows that legacy doesn’t begin on a platform—it begins in God’s presence.

Reflect

How could your private time with God today shape how people remember your life tomorrow?



Dessert — The Legacy of a Wise Heart

God gave Solomon abundant wisdom and understanding “like the sand that is on the seashore,” and his wisdom exceeded that of all the surrounding nations.

The story of Solomon reminds us that real greatness starts with a listening heart. When we ask for wisdom instead of applause, God can use our lives to bless people we may never meet.

□ CST Reflection

Finish this quietly: “Lord, help me want _____ more than _____.”

To-Go Box

- The strength of your leadership flows from the sincerity of your prayers.
- God is pleased when you ask for wisdom to serve others well.
- Solomon’s legacy began not with a throne, but with a conversation with God.

Carry this truth into your week:

Ask God for wisdom first—then trust Him with everything else.

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for the example of Solomon’s request. Teach me to value wisdom over wealth and understanding over image. Align my heart with Your priorities so that my prayers please You. Give me an understanding heart to serve well wherever You have placed me. Let my life reflect Your wisdom and bring You honor. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Activity – “Wisdom First” (Fill-in-the-Blank)

Complete the statements based on today’s lesson:

1. Solomon asked God for _____ and _____ to govern His people.
2. God was pleased because Solomon did *not* ask for _____, _____, or the _____ of his enemies.
3. Solomon’s legacy teaches us that _____ comes before _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Note Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study

Use this space to jot down insights, testimonies, or key points from group discussion:

BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus

Prayer the First Resort

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** Luke 5:15–16; Luke 11:1–4; Luke 18:1–8; John 17

 **Key Verse:** Luke 18:1 (WEB)

“He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up;”

Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16

¹⁵ But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶ But he withdrew himself into the desert, and prayed.”

Crowds kept coming. Needs kept growing. Pressure kept rising. And Jesus did something that still challenges us: **He withdrew to pray.** He didn’t wait until everything broke. He didn’t treat prayer like a backup plan. If we’re asking *WWJD*—here’s a clear answer: **He would pray first, especially when life got louder.**

Reflection Question

When your life gets busier or more stressful, what usually gets cut first—rest, fun, prayer, or something else?

Main Course – The Mediator and the Model

Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4

¹ When he finished praying in a certain place, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, just as John also taught his disciples.”

² He said to them, “When you pray, say,
‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy.
May your Kingdom come.
May your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven.

³ Give us day by day our daily bread.

⁴ Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone who is indebted to us.
Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.’

The disciples didn't ask Jesus to teach them crowds, platforms, or popularity—they asked about prayer. They watched His life and realized **prayer was the engine**. Jesus gave them a pattern: start with God's holiness and Kingdom, trust Him for daily needs, walk in forgiveness, and ask for strength in temptation.

Reflection Question

Which part of that pattern do you rely on most—worship, daily needs, forgiveness, or spiritual strength? Which part do you skip?

Bite 2 — Don't Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5

¹ He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up, ² saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn't fear God, and didn't respect man. ³ A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’

⁴ He wouldn't for a while; but afterward he said to himself, ‘Though I neither fear God, nor respect man, ⁵ yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.’

Jesus tells a story about persistence because He knows how the mind and heart works. Delay can make you tired. Silence can make you doubt. But Jesus is clear: **don't give up**.

Reflection Question

Is there something you used to pray about that you stopped praying for because it took too long?

Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge, Luke 18:6–8

⁶ The Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷ Won't God avenge his chosen ones, who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸ I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?”

CST Thought

God keeps His promises—always. Even in seasons of delay or confusion, His Word sustains us.

Jeremiah 29 reminds us to seek God, pray for the welfare of the place we're in, and trust His larger plan for our lives.

Author's Testimony – A Lesson in Trust

One morning, I began my day with prayer:

“Lord, please be in charge of today. Allow me to rely on Your peace. Take control of today.”

Before 8 a.m., everything seemed to go sideways. A tenant's water was shut off, and there were other moving pieces that could have easily sent me into stress mode. But instead of panicking, I felt an unexpected peace.

God quietly reminded me, “Just call the local store.”

I did. They gave me the name of a retired plumber. He came out, fixed the issue, and the cost was exactly the \$40 I had withdrawn the night before—without knowing why I would need it. That's God's foresight and favor.

Reflection Questions

1. What situation did you trust Jesus to handle, and what was the result?

Dessert — Prayer that Unites, John 17:20–21

“Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who believe in me through their word, that they may all be one, even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me.”

Even before the cross, Jesus prayed for us. He sought the Father for strength, direction, and surrender. That's the model: **prayer in the beginning, prayer in the middle, prayer at the finish.**

To-Go Box

- This life is not over until your last breath.
- Keep praying. Keep trusting. Keep resting in the One who intercedes for you.
- “Pray without ceasing.” (1 Thessalonians 5:17, WEB)

Carry this truth into every season: Jesus still meets you first in prayer.

 Group Prayer – Following Jesus’ Example

Remember Jesus’ prayer in Gethsemane and His High Priestly prayer in John 17. Pray for unity, peace, and strength.

“Lord, help us to surrender our will to Yours. Teach us to rest in Your promises, and fill us with the same glory and unity You shared with the Father. Make us one in heart and purpose.

In Jesus’ name, amen.”

 Notes Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM1 — Lesson 4 Paul & Silas

Faith in the Dark

 **Theme:** Prayer, The First Resort/Praise in Midnight Moments

 **Background Text:** Acts 16:16–34; Isaiah 26:3; Phil 4:6–7

 **Key Verse:** Acts 16:25–26 (WEB)

But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone's bonds were loosened."

Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3

You will keep whoever's mind is steadfast in perfect peace, because he trusts in you.

Although no one was promised the “Easy St” while spreading the Word of God, your trust that you have in him, no matter the situation is the setup for victory. God promises perfect peace to those who fix their minds on Him. His peace is not the absence of trouble, but a deep, enduring confidence in His unchanging nature.

Reflection Question

When has God given you peace when everything around you said panic?

Main Course – Power in the Praises

Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31

²²The multitude rose up together against them, and the magistrates tore their clothes off of them, and commanded them to be beaten with rods. ²³When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely, ²⁴who, having received such a charge, threw them into the inner prison, and secured their feet in the stocks."

Paul and Silas helped set a slave girl free from a spirit that was controlling her.
Instead of getting a “thank you,” they were:

- Stripped
- Beaten
- Thrown into the **inner prison**
- Locked in stocks

Oftentimes we don't hear an immediate 'thank you' for doing what is right. Our response shouldn't be based on what they do in return, but when he has called us to do – period. That's the test, our follow-through produces the testimony.

Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26

²⁵ But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. ²⁶ Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone's bonds were loosened."

God answers in a wild way:

- Earthquake
- Open doors
- Loose chains

It's amazing what can happen when you keep your mind stayed on Him (see Isaiah 26:3). Their voices turned a prison into a sanctuary, and their pain became a praise report. Sometimes your midnight melody becomes someone else's breakthrough song. **That's what made the jailhouse rock!** Certain songs, like "Holy Forever" by CeCe Winans, strengthen my heart when life feels heavy because they lift my focus off the problem and onto His power.

Reflection Question

What worship song or prayer brings you back to peace when life feels heavy?

Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30

²⁷ The jailer, being roused out of sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, 'Don't

harm yourself, for we are all here!’ ²⁹ He called for lights and sprang in, and, fell down trembling before Paul and Silas, ³⁰ and brought them out and said, ‘Sirs, what must I do to be saved?’

CST Thought

“Do thyself no harm”

The guard fell asleep on duty, and it could have cost him his life! He didn’t want to face his boss and try to explain why the prison was empty (with dried drool on his face)! Paul and Silas’s praise didn’t just free them—it freed everyone in earshot.

The first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stayed, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line. Their pain became the door to someone else’s **salvation**.



Word Study

Yadah (Hebrew) –means praise



Reflection Question

Who has been influenced by your praise or perseverance?



Dessert – Joy Unspeakable Joy, Acts 16:31–34

³¹ They said, ‘Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household.’ ³² They spoke the word of the Lord to him, and to all who were in his house.

³³ He took them the same hour of the night, and washed their stripes, and was immediately baptized, he and all his household. ³⁴ He brought them up into his house, and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly, with all his household, having believed in God.”

CST Commentary

Praise is contagious, and faith is transferable. Paul and Silas’s obedience led to the warden’s family’s salvation. The first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stayed, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line. Their pain became the door to someone else’s **salvation**.

What began as a night of pain ended in joy—unspeakable joy.

To-Go Box

- When you choose praise over panic, God moves immediately.
- He can still shake foundations, open doors, and loose chains—not just yours, but everyone within reach of your faith.
- No matter what the problem, Jesus will always be the answer.

Carry this truth into every season:

Your midnight praise can become somebody else's morning miracle.

Prayer

“Lord Jesus, Thank You for being with us in our midnight moments. Teach us to choose praise over panic and to trust that You are working even when we cannot see it. Let our worship create an atmosphere where others can experience freedom, salvation, and joy. Use our pain as a platform for Your power. In Your name we pray, amen.”

Reflection & Group Discussion

1. When has God used a hard season in your life to encourage someone else?

2. What is one “midnight situation” you need to surrender to God in praise right now?

3. Who comes to mind when you think about someone who needs to “hear” your praise?

 Group Reflection

Sometimes when the Spirit prompts you to shout or praise, it's not just for you.
Someone within earshot might need that breakthrough.
Glory be to God for every chain that falls when we praise.

 Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key

Theme: Prayer, the First Resort

Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best

Activity – Mix & Match

Match each name/phrase with the correct description:

Match		Name/Phrase		Description
B	1	Haman	A	Esther's Uncle
A	2	Mordecai	B	Wanted to destroy Jews
D	3	Vashti	C	Death for coming without summons
C	4	Why Fast was called	D	Refused to come when summoned
E	5	How Haman died	E	By hanging at the Gallows

Answer Key:

- 1 → b (Haman – plotter who wanted to destroy the Jews)
- 2 → a (Mordecai – cousin who refused to bow)
- 3 → d (Vashti – former queen removed)
- 4 → c (The Fast – three days before Esther went to the king)
- 5 → e (The Gallows – where Haman was executed)

Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Solomon asked God for _____ and _____ to govern His people.
2. God was pleased because Solomon did not ask for _____, _____, or the _____ of his enemies.
3. Solomon’s story shows that _____ comes before _____.

Answer Key:

1. wisdom and understanding
2. long life, riches/wealth, or the death/lives of his enemies
3. wisdom comes before wealth

Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort

Activity – “Prayer Map” (Gethsemane-style prayer)

This activity is reflective, not right-or-wrong:

- Students write a two-part prayer:
 - “Father, I feel...” (honesty)
 - “Nevertheless, Your will be done in...” (surrender)

Answer Key:

- Open-ended/journaling. No fixed correct answers.

Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark



Activity – “Midnight Playlist” (or your final title)

Students:

1. Write one worship song or phrase that helps them focus on God.
2. Complete: “When I feel _____, this reminds me that God is _____.”

Answer Key:

- Open-ended/journaling. No fixed correct answers.